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SWMS-06 · CONCRETE OR ASPHALT CUTTING

Code	SWMS-06
Version	V12.0
High-risk construction work	CONCRETE OR ASPHALT CUTTING
Scope	High-risk construction work involving concrete or asphalt cutting.
Status	APPROVED
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PREPARED / APPROVED

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Date prepared	2025-08-31
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Date approved	2025-08-31

ACTIVITY & HAZARD ANALYSIS

#	Step	Hazards	Before	Controls	Resp.	After
1	Training of operator	· An untrained operator is a danger to himself and others	1	· Make sure the operator is familiar with the type of equipment they are going to use and are trained in the supplier's safe use manual and is able to operate the equipment to the supplier's recommendations. · Make sure the operator understands what the hazards associated with the cutting operation are, why the risks need to be controlled and how the risks are to be controlled. · Make sure the operator understands what protective equipment is needed, why it is needed, and how it is to be fitted and used.	Management, Supervisor	2
2	Protection of other workers and the public	· Flying debris	1	· Barricades and signs may be needed to warn people who may be at risk from the cutting operation.	Supervisor	2
3	Type and condition of the concrete	· Obstructions or resistance in the material being cut – can cause sudden kick-back, pushback or pull-in movements of the saw	1	· Check whether the material contains reinforcing steel, electrical cable conduits, gas pipes or other services. · Service plans should be checked to ensure that live services will not be cut by the saw.	Supervisor	2
4	Confined spaces	· Carbon monoxide	1	· Petrol driven equipment should not be used in confined spaces because of the potential for carbon monoxide poisoning.	Supervisor	2
5	Electrical equipment in wet conditions	· Electrocution	1	· If electrical equipment is used in wet conditions, the potential for electrocution needs to be considered and be guarded against.	Supervisor	2
6	Personal Protective Equipment	· Cuts · Noise (hearing loss) · Dust · Flying debris	3	· Safety helmet; Safety footwear; Safety goggles; Face shield; Hearing protection; Sun and weather protection; Gloves to improve grip and reduce force and vibration; Respiratory protection where hazardous dusts or fumes cannot be eliminated.	Operator	3

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#	Step	Hazards	Before	Controls	Resp.	After
7	Using the equipment — Setting Up	· Manual handling sprains and strains · Noise (hearing loss) · Vibration (circulatory damage) · Electricity (electric shock) · Surfaces slippery from cutting residue (falls, sprains) · Dust	1	· Exact location of the cut or penetration is clearly marked on the work area. · A trolley supports the cutting machine for horizontal work at low level so operators do not bend forward or work on their knees. · Cutting blade is the right size and type for the machine. · Blade is in good working condition (no cracks, gaps, warping, deterioration). · Electrically powered machines protected at power outlet with RCD. · Appropriate barricading and warning signs erected. · Adequate lighting provided. · Method of collecting residue in place to prevent slippery surfaces.	Operator	2
8	Before cutting operation	· Cuts · Manual handling sprains and strains · Noise (hearing loss) · Vibration (circulatory damage) · Electricity (electric shock) · Surfaces slippery from cutting residue (falls, sprains) · Dust	1	· General condition of equipment checked by operator before each job (cutting tool, guards, leads, hydraulic hoses). Tag out defective equipment. · Cutting speed matches drive speed per manufacturer's specification. · Shaft and flanges clean and undamaged. · Blade fits securely over the shaft. · Shaft nut securely tightened against outside flange. · Blade guard fitted and in good working order. · Drive belt tensioned correctly. · Adequate coolant or water readily available for wet cutting.	Operator	2
9	During the cutting operation	· Cuts · Manual handling sprains and strains · Noise (hearing loss) · Vibration (circulatory damage) · Electricity (electric shock) · Surfaces slippery from cutting residue (falls, sprains) · Dust	1	· Blade guard in lowered position. · When starting, operator and others stand outside path of blade. · If machine stalls, raise blade and check outside flange/nut for tightness. · When resuming, blade aligned with previous cut. · Wall cuts performed with operator's back close to vertical, hands not above shoulder height. · Cut from a standing posture with feet braced and body balanced; kneel on one knee with knee protection when needed. · Cutting horizontally across a wall, hands at waist height. · Minimise time in fixed postures. · Plenty of water/coolant to suppress dust at point of generation (critical for silica risk). · Throttle lock only used when starting the equipment. · Stop equipment when changing grip between horizontal and vertical cuts. · Use the provided handles to support equipment (do not support by belt guard). · Electrical leads not cut during operation; mind water/electrocution risks. · Assistants located clear of saw movement, ejected material, dropped machine, falling offcuts. · Saw used only with blade rotating opposite to cut direction; not used for inverted cutting. · Hand saw never used above shoulder height. · Hand saw work practices minimise kick backs.	Operator	2
10	Working alone	· Inability to respond to incident/emergency without assistance	1	· Do not work alone as this can be hazardous because of the potential need to provide assistance in the event of an unsafe incident or emergency.	Supervisor, Operator	2
11	Maintenance	· Equipment failure / various	1	· Equipment inspected and maintained regularly by a competent person.	Supervisor	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISKS

Activity	Risk	Before	Controls	Resp.	After
Emergencies	Accident/Incident, Fire, Spill	1	· Personnel advised at toolbox meeting and prepared. · Emergency numbers available on site. · Fire extinguishers / First aid kits / Spill kits on site.	Supervisor, All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes, Dust	2	· Control exhaust emissions (regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit emission control). · Dampen milled surface with water cart. · Use water cart where required.	Supervisor, All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience from works/traffic management	2	· Identify potentially impacted parties. · Letter drops to notify residents/businesses.	Supervisor, All	3
Flora & Fauna	Vegetation removal; native fauna risk from excavation	2	· Assess work area for significant vegetation / faunal habitat — define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. · Machinery thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds present.	Supervisor, All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Loss/destruction of artifacts; disturbance of historical sites	1	· Undertake site survey for significant areas (client rep / government bodies). · Develop project-specific procedure. · Install exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor, All	2
Noise & Vibration	Noise sensitivity to public and fauna	1	· Work during normal hours where possible. · Affected residents notified. · Plant regularly serviced with efficient mufflers. · Use smaller plant to reduce vibration.	Supervisor, All	2
Soil Management & Water Quality	Off-site soil impacts; stockpile damage; mud on roadways	2	· Wash down machinery only in nominated areas (>20m from waterways). · Use only approved stockpile areas. · Build bund walls from available site material. · Drivers check vehicle tyres/bodies for mud build-up.	Supervisor, All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Waterway contamination from spillages	1	· Store per standards; minimise on-site storage away from drains. · All containers labelled; SDS available on site. · Drums stored securely in bunded area. · Spill kits available. · Regular maintenance of plant hoses. · Correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor, All	2
Visual Impact / Waste Management	Litter / dust / mud / lighting impact on residents and waterways	2	· Use site induction to communicate tidy-site requirement. · Inspect site frequently; insist on tidiness. · Keep public roads free of dirt/mud. · Repair broken-out paved surfaces ASAP. · Remove all rubbish from site daily. · Waste recycled where possible.	Supervisor, All	3

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT

- Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts
- Safety Boots
- Sunscreen
- Broad Brimmed Sun Hat
- Sunglasses
- Gloves specific to the task
- White reflective overalls/night
- Hard Hat where required
- Safety Glasses
- Hearing protection where required
- Long clothing
- Dust masks
- Respiratory equipment if required

TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

- Task Specific Training depending on activity
- Current Construction Induction Card
- Client Site Induction (where required)
- Activity Induction (SWMS & SWPs)
- Vehicle Licences (car or truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)
- Plant Operator licences or competency assessments where required
- Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management
- First Aid certificate training
- Manual Handling training
- Fire Extinguisher training
- Fatigue Management Training

EQUIPMENT LIST

- Cutting machine (concrete saw)
- Trolley to support cutting machine
- Cutting blade
- Blade guard
- Electrically powered machines
- Residual current device (earth leakage circuit breaker)
- Water (for wet cutting / dust suppression)
- Spill kits
- Fire extinguishers
- First aid kits
- Water cart

EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

General: Personnel advised at toolbox meeting and prepared in the event of an incident occurring. Emergency numbers available on site. Fire extinguishers / First aid kits / Spill kits on site.

Accident / Incident: Provide first aid; call 000 if required; notify Supervisor immediately; secure the area; preserve evidence; complete Incident Report in Paneltec app.

Fire: Raise alarm; evacuate to muster point; use appropriate fire extinguisher if safe; call 000; notify Supervisor.

Spill: Stop source if safe; contain using spill kit; protect drains/waterways; notify Supervisor; arrange disposal per SDS.

ATTENDANCE & SIGN-OFF

All workers must read this SWMS and sign below, confirming they understand the controls and accept their responsibilities.

Name	Trade / Role	Date	Signature

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